



Apps > Strategy Lab

ADVANCED TRADER · APPS

Strategy Lab

The Strategy Life Cycle as software. Design → Curation → Deployment. Two modes: Basic and Pro.

Same three steps for everyone. Basic keeps the path short. Pro opens power tools without skipping gates. Most ideas die in Design. Process outcomes only — never profit promises.

Execution partner: Tradier — paper/virtual first, then live. Optional TradingView alerts can feed signals; Labs owns Spec, brakes, and logs.

WORKSPACE COMING SOON This hub is the map · tool + courses ship from backlog

Basic and Pro

One product, two surfaces. Toggle anytime — Pro is progressive disclosure, not a free pass past Design honesty.

Basic DEFAULT

Templates, few choices, one-button tests, one strategy in the book. Finish the cycle without drowning.

DESIGN

- Start from a template (e.g. afternoon iron condor)
- Few fields: structure, time, size, simple exit
- One-click test — costs on, holdout automatic
- Five numbers + plain-language verdict

CURATION

- Focus on one strategy at a time
- Simple health: active or sick
- Size: 1 contract or fixed dollars

DEPLOYMENT

- Guided paper-first campaign
- Clear start and end dates
- Log + short retrospective checklist

Pro OPT-IN

Full Spec power, variations, multi-strategy book, denser metrics — still the same three gates.

DESIGN

- Blank Spec or templates; full strike recipes
- Stack filters, custom exits, slip stress
- A/B variations and richer metric pack
- Optional quant labels (train vs holdout, PF, ...)

CURATION

- Book limit (e.g. up to 3) with health labels
- Group / diversify notes
- Size policies: fixed risk, % capital, per strategy

DEPLOYMENT

- Multi-strategy campaigns
- Prune tools and fuller campaign log
- Automation / bots later — frozen Spec only

Rules both modes share: Risk Shell required · costs stay on for tests · no mid-campaign rule rewrites · kill with a written reason is success of the filter.

The three steps

One path in Basic and Pro. Kill is normal at every step — professional hygiene, not a failure of nerve.

STEP 1**Design**

Idea · model · test · sim

**STEP 2****Curation**

Health · group · size · monitor

**STEP 3****Deployment**

Campaign · log · prune · retro

Inside each step

Design is where the builder and backtester live. Curation protects the book. Deployment is a campaign with an end date.

STEP 1

Design

Turn a simple idea into written rules, then prove them honestly on history before they touch a book.

INCLUDES

- Hypothesis — simple, style-fit, explainable in 30 seconds
- Model — market, structure, entry, exit, risk shell
- Test — costed backtest with a holdout the strategy never saw
- Sim check — optional paper on live data before the book

YOU WILL PRACTICE

- Write a Spec a peer can follow
- Kill ideas that need discretionary fog
- Costs on, freeze params, read holdout honestly

STEP 2

Curation

Choose which survivors join a small book — health, grouping, and size — not every design that “worked once.”

INCLUDES

- Categorize — new, in-process, mature, or sick
- Group — low correlation, balanced risk, diversified where it helps
- Size — fixed dollar, fixed risk, or proportional to capital
- Monitor — quiet book vs signals that need attention

YOU WILL PRACTICE

- Keep a hard book limit (few strategies, not dozens)
- Mark sick strategies early — RIP is professional hygiene
- Size from risk shell, not hope

STEP 3**Deployment**

Run a time-boxed campaign: capital, dates, log, prune, retrospective — then feed lessons back into Design.

INCLUDES

- Strategies in the campaign (frozen Specs only)
- Capital allocation across the book
- Start / end dates — campaigns end on purpose
- Log, prune, retrospective → next Design cycle

YOU WILL PRACTICE

- Paper or tiny size before full capital
- No mid-campaign rule rewrites (new version = new Design)
- One written lesson after every campaign

Execution rails

Used mainly in Deployment (and optional Design sim). One broker target in v1 so the path is dogfoodable end-to-end.

Tradier (target)

Primary venue for paper and live campaigns. API-first, options multi-leg. Partnership path for distribution — not a black-box money machine.

TradingView (reach + funnel)

Charts, ideas, and optional alerts into Labs. Not the risk system of record. Webhooks create candidates; they do not silently size live capital.

How you enter

Same three steps either way — different front door when the workspace ships.

Validate what you already trade

Capture today's rules as a Design Spec, test honestly, then decide if it earns a Curation slot — or dies with a reason.

YOU WILL LEARN

- Separate "I trade this" from "this earned a book slot"
- Find the weak gate: Design test vs adherence vs sick performance
- Write a keep / curate / kill decision

Develop a new edge

Hypothesis first, many Designs, few curated. Throughput of honest kills is a feature.

YOU WILL LEARN

- Generate simple, style-fit ideas without shiny-object chase
- Use Design → Curation → Deployment as the only path to capital
- Keep the live book under a hard limit

The one rule

The scoreboard is process — not win rate.

Kill early

Most ideas die in Design. A kill with a written reason is the filter working. Capital only after Curation — never from a hot backtest alone.

Metrics that matter

Drawdown bounds, expectancy, adherence, honest holdout checks, book health. Win rate is never the headline.

Connected tools

The Life Cycle sits above Practice Log and Playbook — it does not replace them.

Practice Log LIVE

Trade Log and Journal — evidence during Deployment (fills, adherence, daily routine).

[Open →](#)

Journey LIVE

Curriculum progress. Strategy Lab courseware deep-links into each of the three steps.

[Open →](#)

Playbook COMING SOON

Allowed setups. Curated strategies should match what you actually trade.

On the Apps board when it ships.

Statistics COMING SOON

Process metrics — adherence and discipline, never profit claims as the headline.

On the Apps board when it ships.

Courseware

Courses for this app — backlog. Assessment stays process-only (gates, kills, adherence) — never P&L grades.

SLC-01 IN BACKLOG

Strategy Lab Overview

The whole map: Design → Curation → Deployment, plus Basic vs Pro. Why most ideas die, why the book stays small, and how this sits on FatTail doctrine.

STUDENTS WILL LEARN

- Name and explain the three steps and when to use Basic vs Pro
- Use the one rule: kill early; capital only after Design gates
- Place the Lab next to Practice Log and Playbook

SLC-02 IN BACKLOG

Design — Spec, Risk Shell & Test

Idea → model → costed history with holdout. Emphasis on explainability, defined risk, and honest kills.

STUDENTS WILL LEARN

- Complete a Spec and Risk Shell
- Run a costed test and read train vs holdout
- Freeze a version or kill with a written reason

SLC-03 IN BACKLOG

Curation — Book & Health

Assemble a small team of strategies: health labels, grouping, and position sizing — not a pile of backtests.

STUDENTS WILL LEARN

- Categorize new / in-process / mature / sick
- Apply a hard book limit
- Choose a size policy aligned to risk tolerance

SLC-04 IN BACKLOG

Deployment — Campaigns

Time-boxed live or paper campaigns: capital, log, prune, retrospective back into Design.

STUDENTS WILL LEARN

- Open and close a campaign with dates
- Log every session; prune sick strategies mid-campaign if needed
- Extract one process lesson for the next Design cycle

SLC-05 IN BACKLOG

Validate a Live Strategy

For traders who already run an edge: import rules, re-run Design honesty, then curate or kill.

STUDENTS WILL LEARN

- Capture what you actually trade as a Spec
- Find the weakest gate
- Produce a written keep / curate / kill decision

Published courses will appear in the [course library](#).

[← All Apps](#) · [Practice Log](#)